Universal Human Values – II (UHV-II)

Module 1 · Session 7 — Student Activity Worksheet

Practice Session 1 — Exploring our Aspirations and Concerns

Session	7	**Lecture**	PS 1
Topic	Practice Session 1 — Exploring our Aspirations and Concerns (basic aspiration vs the steps to fulfil it)		
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Session Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, the student should be able to:

- Distinguish between the basic aspiration and the steps (become/do/get) to fulfil it.
- Recognise that the basic aspiration is to be happy and prosperous.
- Plan with clarity of basic aspiration rather than only the steps.

How to Engage with this Session (The Process)

- Whatever is said is a proposal — do not assume it to be true or false.
- Verify it on your own right, on the basis of your natural acceptance.
- It is a dialogue: first with the teacher, then within your own self — between what you are and what you really want to be.

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- We are all making tremendous effort; that effort is to fulfil aspirations or to resolve concerns.
- Present effort → become something → get/do something → be something (happy and prosperous).
- Becoming/doing/getting are only steps; the goal, the basic aspiration, is to be happy and prosperous.
- With clarity of basic aspiration the direction of effort is definite; without it, effort can keep changing.
- If a favourite path is closed, the appropriate response is to find an alternate path, not to be depressed.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1 — Aspirations, Achievements and Concerns

List a few of your own in each column.

Aspirations	Achievements	Concerns
Achieving continuous peace and happiness.	Securing academic admission.	Stress during examinations and future careers
Maintaining strong, trust-based relationships.	Making dependable friends.	Misunderstandings in family and social settings
Becoming prosperous and self-reliant.	Acquiring technical skills.	Environmental pollution and resource scarcity

Activity 2 — Why Am I Making This Effort?

Trace one of your efforts through the four steps.

Present effort	→ Become something	→ Get / do something	→ Be something?
Studying technical coursework	Becoming a qualified enginee	Securing a job and earning an income	Experiencing continuous happiness and prosperity

Which of these is your basic aspiration (1, 2, 3 or 4)? Are the rest just steps toward it?

Activity 3 — How Are You Planning Your Life?

Tick one and explain in a line:

- 1-2-3-4: plan the steps without being clear of the basic aspiration, OR
- 4-3-2-1: get clarity of the basic aspiration first, then work out the steps.

4-3-2-1: get clarity of the basic aspiration first, then work out the steps.

Starting with clarity about the final aspiration ensures every intermediate step remains aligned with true fulfilment.

Activity 4 — When the Favourite Path is Closed

Recall a situation where your "favourite" path was closed (branch, college, roommate…). What did you feel, think and do? What would be the appropriate response?

Reflection: When a preferred option (like a college branch) becomes unavailable, initial reactions can include frustration or anxiety.

Appropriate Response: Recognizing that the choice was merely a pathway toward the ultimate goal (happiness and prosperity) allows an individual to adapt, re-align effort, and pursue alternative pathways calmly.

Home Assignment — What Is Required to Fulfil Each?

For each aspiration or concern, mark what is required: right understanding, fulfilment in relationship, and/or physical facility.

Aspiration or Concern	Right understanding	Fulfilment in relationship	Physical facility
Good health	Yes	No	Yes
Lasting friendships	Yes	Yes	No
Career Success	Yes	Yes	Yes
Peace of mind	Yes	Yes	No

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

Q1. Using the sequence "present effort → become something → get/do something → be something," explain how our various efforts are only steps toward one basic aspiration. What is that basic aspiration?

Human actions follow a clear progression:

1. **Present Effort:** Enrolling in courses, working jobs, practicing skills.
2. **Become Something:** Graduating, securing a profession, acquiring status.
3. **Get / Do Something:** Earning wealth, purchasing goods, performing roles.
4. **Be Something:** Experiencing contentment, happiness, and peace.

Q2. Compare life with clarity of basic aspiration and life without clarity of basic aspiration.

Life with Clarity: Direction remains stable. Setbacks in intermediate steps are treated as simple logistical adjustments. Effort leads directly to peace, harmonious relationships, and prosperity.

Life without Clarity: Focus centers on intermediate steps (money, degrees, status) as if they were final goals. This confusion leads to endless competition, anxiety, instability, and frustration when plans change.

Q3. When a “favourite path” to what we assume to be our goal is closed, what is the appropriate response, and why?

Appropriate Response: Re-evaluate options calmly and select an alternative route without despair.

Reason: Specific paths (such as a career or academic track) are merely mechanisms to reach the primary objective: continuous happiness and prosperity. Closing one path does not eliminate the core goal, making flexibility and adaptive effort the proper choice.